

Chicago Tribune



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Charges sought in CBP shooting

Attorneys say new analysis shows Chicago woman was moving away from agent who opened fire

By Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Attorneys for Marimar Martinez, shot by a Border Patrol agent during Operation Midway Blitz last October, called on authorities Monday to file criminal charges against the agent after a new bullet trajectory analysis showed her car was moving away from the agent when he opened fire.

"This in our opinion is not a political issue," attorney Christopher Parente said at a news conference to announce the filing of a federal lawsuit. "We are asking the Department of Justice to do something. It's the Department of Justice. It's not the Department of Republicans. It's not the Department of Democrats. They have a civil rights division specifically there to investigate things like this."

Parente said if federal authorities refused to act, he's hopeful that an ongoing Chicago police investigation will lead to charges being filed by Cook County State's Attorney Eileen Burke, who has promised to have a specialized unit of prosecutors look at the evidence that's been gathered.

The 33-page lawsuit filed in U.S. District Court on Monday afternoon landed a year and a day after Martinez, a Montessori school teacher's aide, was seriously wounded in the Oct. 4, 2025, shooting in Brighton Park as she was heading to a local

church to donate clothes.

The suit named only the United States as a defendant, since federal agents are generally barred from being sued for on-duty actions. It included seven total counts of negligence, battery, assault, intentional infliction of emotional distress, malicious prosecution, and false arrest and imprisonment.

While much of the evidence presented in the lawsuit was already known, it included the results of a newly completed reconstruction of the shooting done by a nationally renowned expert hired by Marti-

nez's attorneys.

The expert, Jeremy Bauer, cross-referenced police body camera and surveillance footage and analyzed the bullet holes in Martinez's vehicle and the wounds in her body to trace Border Patrol Agent Charles Exum's position when the shots were fired, according to Martinez's attorneys.

None of it matched Exum's statements to the FBI that he was standing in front of her car when the shots were fired, or that he stopped firing

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Big climate case begins new term for court

Similar suits filed against oil firms by local governments

By Abbie Vansickle
THE NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — Supreme Court justices wrestled Monday with the first case of their new term, a complex dispute over whether local governments can hold oil companies responsible for the damages of climate change — with billions of dollars potentially hanging in the balance.

Officials in Boulder, Colorado, sued two oil companies, Exxon Mobil and Suncor Energy, claiming that they should be liable for the costs of a changing climate, like droughts, fires and floods.

Depending on its scope, a decision for the oil companies could doom dozens of other similar lawsuits by states, cities and tribes percolating in courts throughout the country.

Most of the arguments Monday were highly technical, focusing on whether federal law blocked these types of lawsuits, and whether the case had reached a point at which the Supreme Court had the power to hear it at all.

But justices across the ideological spectrum, including some conservatives, posed skeptical questions to the oil companies.

With one conservative missing — Justice Samuel Alito recused himself from the case days before the argument — there was the possibility that Boulder would pick up the single vote from the court's remaining five conservatives it would need to prevail. A 4-4 tie in the case would leave in place a Colorado Supreme Court ruling against the oil companies.

Still, some of the conservative justices appeared concerned about whether a ruling for Boulder would flood the courts with climate change lawsuits.

"Presumably if you prevail, the next day, a municipality in every

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BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Memorial grows for 7-year-old girl

Kezia Freeman leaves a stuffed animal and flowers at a memorial on Monday in the 8600 block of South Cottage Grove Avenue in Chicago's Chatham neighborhood where a 7-year-old girl was stabbed to death Saturday while walking with her sister. **Story, Chicagoland Page 3**



Former U.S. House Speaker Dennis Hastert leaves Dirksen U.S. Courthouse in Chicago after sentencing on April 27, 2016. **ZBIGNIEW BZDAK/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

DENNIS HASTERT 1942-2026

Disgraced former GOP US House speaker served prison sentence

He admitted sexually abusing boys he coached at Yorkville

By Rick Pearson, Christy Gutowski and Jason Meisner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

J. Dennis Hastert rose from a rural high school wrestling coach to the heights of power as the longest-serving Republican speaker of the U.S. House before an ignominious fall and

imprisonment amid revelations he sexually abused youths he had coached.

Once the third-most-powerful elected official in the country, serving as speaker from 1999 until 2007, Hastert died Sunday of natural causes at his home in Plano while under hospice care, Kendall County Coroner Jacquie Purcell said. He was 84.

His death came a decade after he was sentenced to 15 months in prison for illegally structuring \$950,000 in bank withdraw-

als to evade federal reporting requirements. The money was for hush payments to one of his victims, identified in court only as Individual A.

Hastert's admission in court that he had sexually abused several boys he coached on the Yorkville High School wrestling team in the 1960s and 1970s left him living a life largely "isolated from society," one of his attorneys said. Friends who

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Apple Fest was too crowded for many

Business owners enjoying the sales say that was the point

By Lila Hempel-Edgers
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For small business owners, it was the kind of blockbuster weekend that makes the slow season manageable. For Chicagoans packed shoulder-to-shoulder, it was a failure of crowd control with no obvious culprit — maybe city officials, maybe online influencers, but certainly not them — that left Lincoln Avenue feeling as crowded as Bourbon Street during Mardi Gras.

The online debate unfolding in the start of the longtime North Side fall festival has attendees and abstainers alike asking the same question: Who is Apple Fest for?

"It's ironic that people are bemoaning the crowds when that's why the event exists," said Emily Wentz, a festival vendor.

By drawing thousands of potential customers to local businesses, the weekend accomplished exactly what it was intended to do, Wentz said. At the booth for an Albany Park stationery shop, a favorite design, she sold more than \$10,000 worth of greeting cards,

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JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

White Sox go up 2-0 over Guardians

Sox come back with three runs in the sixth inning to beat the Guardians for the second straight game in Cleveland, 4-3. The Sox are one win away from the ALCS. **Sports**

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